SOWETO GLOBAL SOLUTIONS

IT & DIGITAL SKILLS LEARNING SERIES

DIGITAL LITERACY CERTIFICATION PREPARATION

Guided Practical Modules Aligned to Global Digital Standards & Exam Domains

Designed for staff members, job seekers, students, and self-taught learners preparing for formal digital qualifications (e.g., ICDL, IC3, MOS, and CompTIA ITF+). This study guide provides structured practice modules, key testing domains, scenario exercises, and test-taking strategies to guarantee exam readiness.

Document Type: Certification Preparation Guide
Published By: Soweto Global Solutions Educational Team
Target Certifications: ICDL, IC3 Digital Literacy, MOS & CompTIA ITF+
Version: Public Edition 2.0

TABLE OF CONTENTS

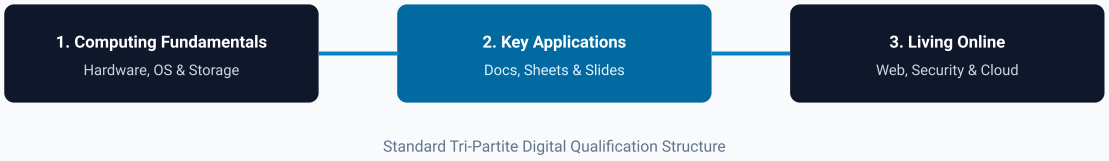
Module	Certification Study Domain	Page
Module 1	Computing Fundamentals, Operating Systems & File Management	2
Module 2	Key Applications: Word Processing, Spreadsheets & Presentations	3
Module 3	Living Online: Web Browsing, Cloud Tools & Cybersecurity Awareness	3
Module 4	Exam Strategy, Practical Scenario Mock Tests & Readiness Checklist	4

MODULE 1: COMPUTING FUNDAMENTALS & OS MASTERY

The first major objective in digital literacy examinations tests your foundational knowledge of computer hardware, operating system navigation, file system structure, and basic maintenance troubleshooting.

> **Exam Weighting:** Typically accounts for 25% to 30% of total exam questions in standard digital literacy assessments (IC3 / ICDL Computer Essentials).

1.1 Certification Blueprint & Core Concepts



Standard Tri-Partite Digital Qualification Structure

1.2 Practical Hands-On Exercise: File Management Task

TASK 1 **Create Directory Structure:** Open File Explorer / Finder. Create a primary folder named `Certification_Exam_Prep`. Inside it, create three subfolders: `/Documents`, `/Data_Sheets`, and `/Media`.

TASK 2 **Execute File Operations:** Move provided exam sample files into their corresponding subfolders. Rename `draft_v1.docx` to `Final_Project_Report.docx`.

TASK 3 **Archive & Compress:** Select all three subfolders, right-click, and select **Compress to ZIP File**. Name the archive `Exam_Submission_JohnDoe.zip`.

MODULE 2: KEY PRODUCTIVITY APPLICATIONS

Examiners test practical proficiency in office productivity suites (Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, or LibreOffice). You must be able to perform document formatting, spreadsheet calculations, and presentation slide creation efficiently.

2.1 Key Application Test Objectives

Application Domain	Required Exam Competencies	High-Frequency Test Tasks
Word Processing	Styles, Margins, Headers/Footers, Tables, Mail Merge	Apply Heading 1 style, insert 3x4 table, set page orientation to Landscape.
Spreadsheets	Formulas, Formatting, Cell Referencing, Charts	Write `=SUM()` & `=AVERAGE()`, lock cells with `$` absolute references, create column charts.
Presentations	Slide Layouts, Transitions, Master Slides, Media Embeds	Insert bulleted list, apply 'Fade' slide transition to all slides, reorder slide sequence.

2.2 Guided Practice: Spreadsheet Formula Exam Simulation

STEP 1 Enter sample values in cells `A1:A10`. In cell `A11`, type `=SUM(A1:A10)` to compute total sum.

STEP 2 Calculate 15% tax in column B by referencing a fixed tax rate in cell `$E$1` using absolute cell referencing: `=A1*$E$1`.

MODULE 3: LIVING ONLINE & CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

The modern digital workspace requires understanding web browsers, cloud storage collaboration, digital communications, and essential security practices to protect hardware and personal data.

3.1 Web & Security Exam Knowledge Matrix

Topic Area	Key Concept / Terminology	Exam Pitfall to Avoid
URL Protocols	`https://` indicates encrypted secure traffic via SSL/TLS.	Do not enter credentials on plain `http://` unencrypted pages.
Phishing Attacks	Fraudulent emails attempting to steal passwords or financial details.	Never click suspicious links or unexpected attachments.
Cloud Storage	Remote file sync enabling real-time multi-user collaboration.	Distinguish between 'View Only' and 'Edit' permission links.

3.2 Guided Practice: Browser & Cloud Safety Checklist

STEP 1 Clear browser cache, cookies, and browsing history via browser setting menus (`Ctrl+Shift+Del`).

STEP 2 Inspect security certificates by clicking the padlock icon next to a website address in the browser bar.

MODULE 4: EXAM STRATEGY & READINESS FRAMEWORK

Passing a timed digital literacy examination requires a balance of speed, accuracy, and test-taking strategy. Most certification exams utilize scenario-based simulation questions alongside multiple-choice items.

4.1 Test-Taking Tactics & Time Management

Exam Scenario	Recommended Strategy	Time Management Rule
Simulation Questions	Use standard menu paths or ribbons rather than unlisted shortcuts if uncertain.	Spend no more than 90 seconds per simulation item.
Multiple Choice	Eliminate obviously incorrect options first before choosing the best answer.	Spend 30–45 seconds per multiple-choice question.
Unsure Answers	Use the 'Flag for Review' feature and move forward immediately.	Return to flagged items in the final 10 minutes of the exam.

4.2 Step-by-Step Exam Day Preparation Workflow



STEP 1 **Complete Mock Practice Test:** Achieve a score of 85% or higher on timed practice simulations before scheduling your formal examination.

STEP 2 **Verify Identification & Testing Environment:** Ensure valid government photo ID is available and that testing software / browser lockdown extensions are pre-installed.

STEP 3 **Review Incorrect Practice Items:** Re-examine missed practice questions to identify topic gaps in file management, spreadsheet formulas, or internet security concepts.

Candidate Final Readiness Assessment Checklist

Complete this checklist before entering the testing center or launching an online proctored exam:

- [ ] Confident creating ZIP archives, managing subfolders, and renaming files.
- [ ] Fluent writing basic spreadsheet formulas (`SUM` , `AVERAGE` , absolute cell referencing `$`).
- [ ] Clear understanding of web security indicators (HTTPS, SSL, Phishing detection).
- [ ] Achieved passing score on at least two timed full-length practice tests.